

Manali Travel Guide

Overview

Manali is a hill town in Himachal Pradesh, nestled in the Kullu Valley along the Beas River. It is a popular base for adventure sports, snow activities, and treks into the Himalayas, and is also a common honeymoon and family holiday destination.

Best Time to Visit

October to February is ideal for snow lovers, with temperatures dropping below freezing in December-January. March to June is pleasant for sightseeing and adventure sports (10-25 degrees Celsius). Monsoon (July-September) can trigger landslides on mountain roads.

Top Attractions

Solang Valley - paragliding, zorbing, and skiing in winter.

Rohtang Pass - high altitude pass with snow for most of the year (permit required, often closed on Tuesdays for maintenance).

Hadimba Devi Temple - an ancient wooden temple set in a cedar forest.

Old Manali - cafes, budget guesthouses, and a laid-back backpacker vibe.

Jogini Waterfall - a moderate trek from Vashisht village.

Vashisht Hot Springs - natural sulphur hot water springs and an old temple.

Local Transport

Local taxis and shared cabs cover most tourist spots. Rohtang Pass requires an online permit and is only accessible by permitted vehicles. Self-drive bike rentals are popular for reaching Old Manali and Solang Valley.

Local Guidelines

Carry warm clothing even in summer as evenings get cold. Acclimatize before heading to higher altitudes like Rohtang Pass to avoid altitude sickness. Plastic bags are banned in Himachal Pradesh - carry cloth bags.

Approximate Costs

Budget stays in Old Manali start around Rs. 800-1500 per night. Mid-range hotels near the Mall Road cost Rs. 3000-5000 per night. Adventure activities like paragliding cost Rs. 2000-3500 per person, and Rohtang Pass taxi packages are around Rs. 2500-3500 per vehicle.